▼ GLASSHOUSE



SOMETHING FISHY

Andhra Pradesh chief minister **N. Chandrababu Naidu** may be 76 years old and serving a fourth term, but he still works hard on projecting a 'grounded' image. The CM has been busy touring remote villages, with the latest 'outreach' unfolding in Nellore district, known for its spicy fish curry, chepala pulusu. Visiting a fishing community last week, Naidu stopped at a fish stall, chatted with women vendors, bought some fish and then visited a local family who cooked a curry for him. His PR machinery was at hand with the cameras, capturing him stirring the dish, sitting cross-legged on the floor, and eating with the fisherman's family. Not everyone is impressed, though. The opposition YSR Congress called it theatre. The party-affiliated Sakshi TV even alleged it was a "low-budget fish market set", pointing to the "brand new" stove and utensils. Cooked-up or not, dining with the poor is one PR strategy every politician loves.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ AUTOWALA NETA

RAJBHAR REVS IT

Suheldev Bharatiya Samaj Party (SBSP) chief **Om Prakash Rajbhar**, who is a minister in the Yogi Adityanath-led BJP government in Uttar Pradesh, is now recasting himself as an "autowala neta". The trigger came on May 22, when deputy CM Brajesh Pathak, speaking at a gathering in Lucknow, commented on how Rajbhar was an autorickshaw driver in Varanasi before entering politics. Soon enough, the opposition Samajwadi Party chief **Akhilesh Yadav** took a swipe at him on social media. Rajbhar hit back by driving around in an autorickshaw on Lucknow's roads on May 24. In a post on X, he said he wanted to remind "Akhilesh and his trolls" that he came from a hard-working background, and accused the SP chief of practising "AC-PC" (air-conditioned press-conference) politics. Rajbhar now claims he will regularly drive an auto-rickshaw from his residence in Gautam Palli to his party office on Park Road.

